Cybercrime Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI/Online Payment Fraud is a common cybercrime in India where attackers trick users into transferring money through digital payment platforms. A real-life inspired example involves a college student who wanted to sell a used phone online. The student listed the product on a marketplace, and soon received a call from a “buyer” claiming interest. Step-by-step, the fraudster built trust by speaking politely and agreeing to pay immediately. Instead of sending money, the attacker sent a “payment request” link via a UPI app and instructed the student to “accept” it to receive payment. Confused but trusting, the student entered their UPI PIN. Instead of receiving money, 10,000 was deducted from their account. Such scams typically target students, elderly people, and individuals unfamiliar with digital payments. Fraudsters exploit lack of awareness and urgency to manipulate victims. The consequences include financial loss, emotional stress, and sometimes leakage of sensitive banking details. Victims often struggle to recover money due to delayed reporting. This case highlights the importance of digital awareness: never enter your UPI PIN to receive money, verify unknown requests, and avoid sharing personal details. Reporting fraud immediately to the bank and cybercrime portal can help reduce damage

Safe Online – Prevention Checklist (For College Students in India)

GENERAL SAFETY TIPS

- Use strong and unique passwords for each account (mix letters, numbers, symbols)
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on email, social media, and banking apps
- Avoid clicking on unknown links in emails, messages, or social media
- Do not share OTP, passwords, or personal details with anyone
- Always check website URLs (look for https:// and correct spelling)
- Keep your phone and laptop updated with latest security patches
- Install apps only from trusted sources like Play Store or App Store
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions

UPI / FINANCIAL SAFETY TIPS

- Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money (PIN is only for sending money)
- Always verify payment requests before approving them
- Do not scan random QR codes sent by strangers
- Set daily transaction limits in your banking apps

REPORTING CYBERCRIME

- Report fraud immediately at: National Cyber Crime Portal
https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
- Call Cybercrime Helpline: 1930 for urgent financial fraud cases